

Contact Us!

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234 W. Baraga Avenue
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MICHIGAN DEPARTMENT OF
CIVIL RIGHTS

*Get
To
Know
Us*

MICHIGAN DEPARTMENT OF **CIVIL RIGHTS**

Only Fair is Fair.



In 1964, Michigan became the first state in the nation to enshrine civil rights protections for all citizens in its constitution in the form of a Civil Rights Commission. Article 5, Section 29 calls on the Commission to ... “investigate alleged discrimination against any person because of race, religion, color or national origin in the enjoyment of the civil rights guaranteed by law and by this constitution...” The Michigan Department of Civil Rights (MDCR) was created in 1965 to carry out the work of the Civil Rights Commission. Passage of the Elliott-Larsen Civil Rights Act and the Persons with Disabilities Civil Rights Act in 1976 further clarified the specific protections guaranteed under Michigan law.

MDCR investigates and resolves discrimination complaints and we work to prevent discrimination through community outreach, educational programs, and partnerships to promote voluntary compliance with civil rights laws. MDCR also provides information and services to businesses on diversity initiatives and equal employment law. Our Federal partners are the Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD) and the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC).

In addition to investigating complaints, our Department is also home to the Michigan Women’s Commission, the Asian Pacific American Affairs Commission, the Division on Deaf and Hard of Hearing and the Hispanic/Latino Commission. MDCR also administers the Michigan Indian Tuition Waiver Program.



Enforcing Civil Rights Laws

Michigan law prohibits discrimination based on religion, race, color, national origin, sex, disability, age, marital status, height, weight, arrest record or disability in some or all of the following:

- * Employment
- * Education
- * Housing
- * Public Accommodation
- * Law Enforcement and
- * Public Service

Any person who believes he or she has been the victim of discrimination can contact the Michigan Department of Civil Rights (MDCR) online or by calling or visiting one of our offices. If the contact is within 180 days of the incident and within our jurisdiction, we will investigate.

Our Enforcement Division resolves more than 2,000 complaints each year. Complaints are resolved through investigation, settlement, and mediation services. If a resolution is not possible and discrimination is found, a formal charge is brought and a hearing is held by the Civil Rights Commission.

For more detailed information on MDCR services, visit www.michigan.gov/mdcr

Preventing Discrimination

MDCR partners with community and faith-based organizations, advocates and local, state and federal law enforcement to share work and provide civil rights assistance.

MDCR offers training to citizens, businesses and community groups on a range of topics, including diversity, disabilities, sexual harassment, Housing Discrimination, Cultural Awareness, Hate Crimes and Civil Rights Law.

The Department leads six strategic initiatives:

- ◆ **The Michigan Alliance Against Hate Crimes** (MIAAHC) is working to eliminate hate crimes and bias incidents in Michigan.
- ◆ **Advocates & Leaders for Police and Community Trust** (ALPACT) brings together law enforcement and community leaders in local communities to better facilitate communication and cooperation.
- ◆ **Anti-Bullying** Partnership is helping communities and schools implement effective anti-bullying policies to protect all students.
- ◆ **Global Michigan** is a statewide effort to create a welcoming environment for immigrants and entrepreneurs.
- ◆ **Migrant and Seasonal Farmworker Task Force** is working on 15 specific efforts to improve conditions in Michigan.
- ◆ **West Michigan Leadership Collaborative** brings organizations together to facilitate strategies and resource development.

Promoting Cultural Awareness

MDCR works to expand cultural awareness and promote tolerance through the efforts of our Divisions and Commissions.

The Women's Commission (MWC), created in 1968, has tackled many issues on behalf of Michigan's women. Current priorities are women in business, women veterans and human trafficking. The MWC is a referral agency to help women access federal, state and local resources.

The Asian Pacific American Affairs Commission's vision is to be an exemplary commission by adding public value to the State of Michigan and the APA community, by fully engaging APAs across the state.

The Division on Deaf and Hard of Hearing serves the needs of deaf, hard of hearing and deaf-blind residents. The Division provides advocacy, interpreter testing, technical assistance, and interpreting services for state government. All Sign Language interpreters must be certified through the Division to practice in Michigan.

The Hispanic/Latino Commission promotes the diverse interests of Hispanics in Michigan in order to help them live lives that are abundant with opportunities.

